

its range of covers, setting w...
 Frank (think neon unicorns and
 dancing dolphins) and a host of
 television shows and movies. Just
 as popular were covers done by
 in-house designers, who seemed
 to have a psychic back door into
 the teenage a...
 scious.
 Trapper Keeper

Sy Joh

By CLA

Sy Johnson, a
 master — pianist,
 arranger, orchestra leader,
 and right-hand man to
 the celebrated bassist
 died on July 26
 was 92.

His wife, Lois,
 death, in a hospi...
 complications o...
 The jazz cr...
 called Mr. John...
 indispensable
 heard much ab...
 jazz world wo...
 started out in t...
 ing piano, first...
 then in New...
 branched out t...
 ing not just wi...
 with a host of...
 including the...
 Konitz and the...
 leader Quincy

He also wro...
 ducted a semi...
 Miles Davis...
 record review...
 quarterly Jazz...
 1970s. He wor...
 and even comp...
 cal, based on...
 Tolkien. And a...
 35-millimeter...
 ing, spontane...
 traits of the jaz...
 and '70s. Many...
 were collected...
 "Jazz: Person...
 Yet for all th...
 mained just o...
 on-stage but in...
 "Gifted as f...
 quite content...
 visible man m...
 brated music...
 ter than they...
 him," Mr. Gidd

Mr. Johnson's work with Min...
 gus covered the last decade of the...
 bassist's life, before he died of Lou...
 Gehrig's disease in 1979. Mr. John...
 son understood how to arrange

Feb. 5, 1937, in Greenville, Ala., a...
 small town south of Montgomery.
 His parents, Ralph and Belle
 (Griggers) Crutchfield, worked at
 a cotton mill.
 Crutch was the first person in
 his family to go to college, gradu...

have a nap space his drawer"
 The Trapper Keeper did all
 three, and more. The germ of the
 idea came to Mr. Crutchfield dur...
 ing a conversation with a sales...
 representative from the West...
 Coast, who told him about a folder...

under would come
 folders, and students were en...
 couraged to buy more as they
 needed them.
 He found the name during a
 martini-fueled lunch with Jon...
 Wyant, his research and develop...

giving them a new
 page for Mead's v...
 picture of several...
 "Being retro never
 nized."
 And on eBay, at...
 Trapper Keeper,
 ture of a boy with...
 on his back, is sell



les Mingus and his wife
 , as photographed by M

Hall death, he worked w...
 New leading musicians...
 re-nist, arranger and...
 gus did the arrangen...
 Tak-Broadway musical...
 ings Night" (1982) an...
 Mr. Blue" (1989). He a...
 gus de-seen musical...
 und bit," based on the...
 Tolkien.

"He was just a
 ord...
 Stites, who was Mr...
 tor at Jazz magaz...
 "ar-...
 phone interview. Th...
 ter jazz writer. Th...
 tographer. He was...
 everything he touc

notes, Mingus called it "the best...
 album I have ever made."
 Mr. Johnson also helped pull off

Greenwich Village.
 Things soured quickly. At one...
 point during a performance, Min...
 gus ordered Mr. Johnson to play

son of mingus's widow, says...
 in an email. "In a world of struggle...
 and populated with adversaries,
 Sy was one of the people Mingus...
 truly trusted."